

WERC Software Release Checklist

Provisional Release

A provisional release is for the entirety of the project. The default branch (i.e. `master` or `main`) will be used for the provisional release.

Provisional releases allow the source code to be made available publicly. This may be in the timely interest of best science, to facilitate external domain and/or technical code reviews (in pursuance of a subsequent official release), or for any other reason deemed acceptable by your center director or equivalent or delegated authority.

A provisional release may not be cited or referenced by other official USGS Information Products (e.g., manuscripts, data releases). Data produced by a provisional release may not be used to support any other official USGS Information Product (e.g., manuscript).

Checklist

- Initiate Software Release Requestion Provisionally
 - ☐ Email Data Management and Cc Research Manager with request with:
 - Title of Release
 - Author List
 - Related IPDS records (paper, data releases)
 - State why you are releasing provisional
 - Will this be released officially in the future?
- Repository Files
 - ☐ Readme
 - ☐ Provisional Disclaimer
 - ☐ License
 - ☐ Metadata – code.json
- Reviews
 - ☐ Administrative security review
 - ☐ WERC repo review
- Request product be made publicly available on a provisional basis with USGS Software
 - ☐ [Submit a new issue](#) using the [GitLab Provisional Release](#) issue template

Official Release

Official releases must reference immutable Git tags. As you work towards an official release, you can use a release candidate branch to facilitate this process. The release candidate branch should have the same name as the eventual release tag. Upon completing the official release process, all other branches, tags, refs, etc... in the associated GitLab project are automatically released as provisional products as well.

The primary distinguisher between a provisional release and an official release are the contents of the DISCLAIMER.md file, the code.json status property, and the ability to cite/reference the released product.

- Initiate Software Release Request Provisionally
 - ☐ Email Data Management and Cc Research Manager with request with:
 - Title of Release
 - Author List
 - Related IPDS records (paper, data releases)
 - Suggested Reviewers for Technical Code and Domain Review
 - ☐ IPDS record created
 - ☐ DOI reserved
- Repository Files
 - ☐ Readme
 - ☐ Official Disclaimer
 - ☐ License
 - ☐ Metadata – code.json
- Reviews
 - ☐ Administrative security review
 - ☐ Technical code review
 - ☐ Domain review
- IPDS Approval
 - ☐ Research Manager Approval
 - ☐ Center Director Approval
- Request product be made publicly available as an official USGS Information Product
 - ☐ Create a release candidate branch titled version number: eg. 1.0.0
 - ☐ [Submit a new issue](#) using the [GitLab Official Release](#) issue template
- WERC repo Review
 - ☐ WERC reviews repo README
 - ☐ WERC assists on deleting release candidate branch and creating a Release branch with an immutable Git tag
 - ☐ DOI goes live
 - ☐ IPDS record disseminated

References

1. <https://code.chs.usgs.gov/software/software-management/-/issues/new>
2. <https://www.usgs.gov/software-management/types-software-review>
3. https://code.chs.usgs.gov/software/software-management/-/raw/main/administrative_templates/DISCLAIMER_preliminary.md
4. https://code.chs.usgs.gov/software/software-management/-/raw/main/administrative_templates/LICENSE.md
5. https://code.chs.usgs.gov/software/software-management/-/raw/main/administrative_templates/code.json
6. <https://git-scm.com/book/en/v2/Git-Basics-Tagging>
7. https://code.chs.usgs.gov/software/software-management/-/raw/main/administrative_templates/DISCLAIMER_official.md